

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 8 4

♥ 4

♦ K Q 8 7 3

♣ 9 8 6

♠ 7 5 2

♥ 8 6

♦ A 9 4

♣ K Q J 10 2



♠ J 10 6

♥ Q J 10 2

♦ J 10 5 2

♣ 7 4

♠ K Q 3

♥ A K 9 7 5 3

♦ 6

♣ A 5 3

West	North	East	South
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Pass

2♣

Pass

1♥

Pass

4♥

3♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

them to force out East's ♥Q. You still have a trump left to stop their ♦s, and as soon as you get the lead you can now run dummy's ♣ suit safely.

South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♦K.

Losers: ♠ = 2 ♥ = 1 or 2 ♦ = 0 ♣ = 0 Total = 3 or 4

In fact if trumps split 5-0 you could have 3 losers in the suit and a disaster. So we won't worry about that possibility. Since the most likely scenario is a 3-2 split you should plan on taking the ♥ A K, then driving out their master trump so you can run dummy's ♣s without somebody ruffing in.

Bad news. West discards a ♦ on the second ♥ lead. Time for a change in plans?

Actually, no. East has 2 master trumps at this point but you still have ♥ 9 7 5 3. So use one of your little ones to drive out East's ♥J. He will probably force you to ruff a ♦, leaving you with ♥ 9 7. Use one of

Suppose you had not driven out both of East's high trumps.

He would have ruffed the third ♣, before you could discard a ♠ loser from your hand. You would lose two trumps and two ♠s.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8
♥ 8 7 6 3
♦ A 9 6 5
♣ J 10 9 8

♠ Q 10 6 3

♥ J 5 2

♦ K Q 3

♣ K 6 4

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W		E
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♠ A K

♥ Q 10 9 4

♦ J 10 8 2

♣ Q 7 2

♠ J 9 7 5 4 2

♥ A K

♦ 7 4

♣ A 5 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South

The correct procedure is to win the ♣A, and immediately play a ♦ to dummy's ♦Q, which holds the trick. Return to your hand with a ♥, and play another ♦ toward dummy. Suppose West takes his ♦A on this trick (otherwise you have no ♦ loser). He can now play a ♣ but you win with dummy's ♣K and discard your small ♣ on dummy's ♦K.

Only then do you lead trumps.

This is the perfect example of when you delay leading trumps.

When you need to do something else first - in this case, to establish a ♦s winner early.

South is to play 4 ♠. West leads the ♣J.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 4

Unless the defense slips you are going to lose the Ace and King of trumps. And the ♦A is a Fast loser that they can take whenever they want to, so that means you must try to dispose of your ♣ loser. The only realistic hope is that West holds the ♦A and you can lead through it twice. So after you win your ♣A do you play a trump?

As much as you'd like to get the trumps out you must work on the ♦s first. Because if you play even one trump the defense will win it and force out your remaining ♣ stopper before you have established a ♦ winner for the discard.